

My One Percent Per Week TQQQ Trading Strategy:

A WINNING EXAMPLE

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In **A WINNING EXAMPLE**, I would like to highlight how one person improved my OPPW TQQQ trading strategy, simply by changing its trading rules.

My intent in this article is to showcase how Carlos Azuero Rodriguez improved his version of the strategy to increase overall performance.¹

My last article, **A WINNER'S GAME** emphasized that the trading strategy had more to offer by adding the proposed improvements. In my recent paper, **THE ANTICIPATED FUTURE**, I showed that the impact would be even more dramatic in the long term, for instance, over the trading interval between years 15 and 20.

The above-cited paper made the case that the strategy has a long-term vision on what should and could be done to continue improving performance over the years. It is also a scalable trading strategy that can help people who want to start small and gradually add funds.

The OPPW TQQQ trading rules used did not change much.

Here are the modified trading rules Carlos has brought to the program that did have an impact:

- 1– **BUY** the opening price on the first trading day of the week. Every week.
 - No change.
- 2– **SELL** at the profit target price, if reached. Type-A trade (gain = 7% or 8.1%+).
 - No change.
- 3– **SELL** (gain = 2.5%) the next day if the price closes below the open.
 - Request a 2.5% profit for Type-C trades. Before, it was 0% to break even.
- 4– **SELL** (loss = -1.5%) the next day if the price closes below -1.3%.
 - Accept the loss of -1.5% if price closes below -1.3%.
- 5– **SELL** at the close on the last trading day of the week.
 - No change. Type-B and Type-D trades.

Line #3 is converting what would have been a Type-C trade with 0% profit to a Type-B trade with a 2.5% profit. The reasoning is simple: if the stock shows some weakness by closing below the open, reduce your profit target to 2.5%. That request is reasonable since the price can rebound and exceed the break-even level. For this strategy, it is a profitable move. Additionally, acceptance of the price weakness indicates a willingness to adapt to market conditions by requesting lower profits.

¹My program code was made available last November 2024 in **Gain Your Financial Freedom**.

Line #4 is also of interest. It gives the price some leeway before accepting a stop-loss. The price has to close below -1.3% before triggering the stop-loss, with still some latitude and wiggle room before reaching its -1.5% exit. This move tends to displace the drawdowns to earlier in the week, rather than at the end of the trading week. Thereby trying to reduce the loss of what would otherwise be a Type-D trade. It shows that once enough price weakness is visible, we might as well get out of the way.

I will present the before and after the modifications.

First to show what was there, and then what could have been. This strategy has a long life. It has a mathematical built-in edge. It capitalizes on the market's volatility and allows prices to fluctuate near their stopping times. The applied and modified trading rules will show that, on average, they were beneficial to the overall strategy results.

Carlos provided the following screenshots below: first, the portfolio metrics, and second, the trade distribution for the strategy before making any program changes.

Figure #1: Portfolio Metrics (Before Modifications).

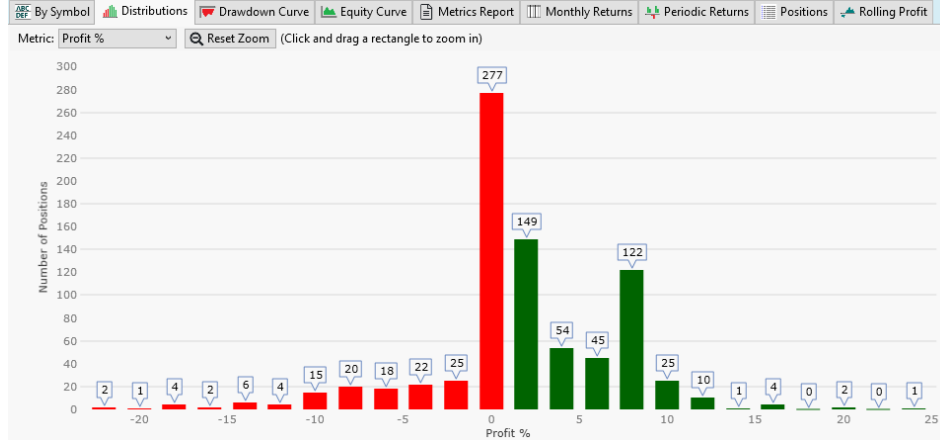
	Strategy	Benchmark (SPY)	Long Only	Short Only
Summary				
Starting Capital	100,000.00	100,000.00	100,000.00	100,000.00
Profit	108,799,517.11	502,548.04	108,799,517.11	0.00
Profit %	108,799.52%	502.55%	108,799.52%	0.00%
Profit Per Bar	15.62	6.43	15.62	-
APR	56.81%	12.25%	56.81%	0.00%
Std Dev of Annual Ret...	154.36%	13.33%	154.36%	0.00%
Exposure	51.09%	99.96%	51.09%	0.00%
Maximum Exposure	99.91%	99.99%	99.91%	0.00%
EAR	111.18%	12.25%	111.18%	-
Alpha (α)	40.19	-	40.19	0.00
Beta (β)	1.36	-	1.36	0.00
Sharpe Ratio	1.30	0.87	1.30	-
Sortino Ratio	2.18	1.29	2.18	-
WL Score	50.19	8.07	50.19	0.00
Slope of Equity Curve	20.397.05	110.03	20.397.05	0.00

([Click here to enlarge](#))

There is no surprise in those two charts (Figures #1 and #2). They yield results close to the ones I had. Carlos' initial version could be slightly different from mine. I can easily accept such a slight difference, as it may depend on having one of the trading rules that is very close to the original version, as already published.

These two figures confirm that we are operating under the same program foundation and trading conditions.

Figure #2: Trade Distribution (Before Modifications).

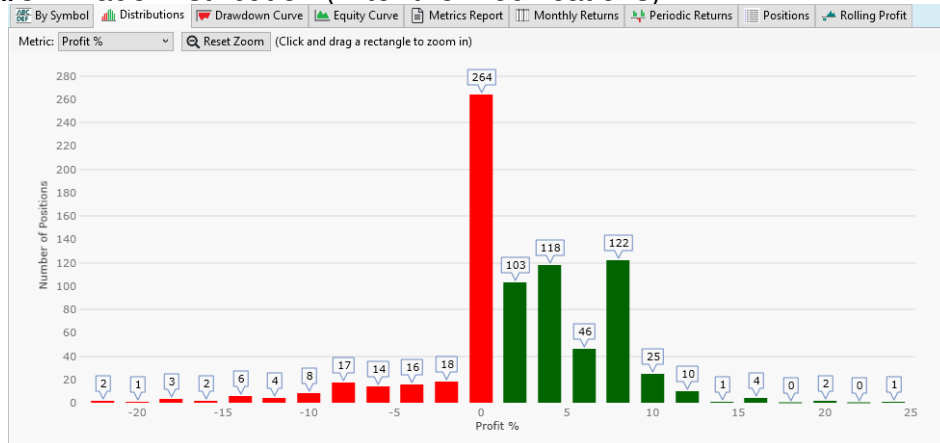


[\(Click here to enlarge\)](#)

What gets interesting is what happens after his program modifications. Here, the performance increases considerably, making his version something special and worth consideration.

After the modifications to the trading rules cited above, the trade distribution changed a little. In the histogram of Figure #3, about 64 trades moved from being negative (red bars) to positive (green bars). The impact was to shift performance higher, transforming some negative results into positive returns.

Figure #3: Trade Distribution (After the Modifications).



[\(Click here to enlarge\)](#)

Overall result: a 67.22% CAGR.

The trade distributions of Figures #2 and #3 appear similar. However, there are differences. We can observe that some of the red trades (negative outcomes) passed to the green side (positive results). This is due to the changed trading rules, which shifted forward some 60 non-producing trades into a profitable zone within a range of 0% and 5%.

Figure #4: Portfolio Metrics (After the Modifications).

	Strategy	Benchmark (SPY)	Long Only	Short Only
Summary				
Starting Capital	100,000.00	100,000.00	100,000.00	100,000.00
Profit	295,802,293.23	502,548.04	295,802,293.23	0.00
Profit %	295,802.29%	502.55%	295,802.29%	0.00%
Profit Per Bar	17.40	6.43	17.40	-
APR	67.22%	12.25%	67.22%	0.00%
Std Dev of Annual Ret...	148.07%	13.33%	148.07%	0.00%
Exposure	52.04%	99.96%	52.04%	0.00%
Maximum Exposure	99.91%	99.99%	99.91%	0.00%
EAR	129.17%	12.25%	129.17%	-
Alpha (α)	51.21	-	51.21	0.00
Beta (β)	1.31	-	1.31	0.00
Sharpe Ratio	1.46	0.87	1.46	-
Sortino Ratio	2.40	1.29	2.40	-
WL Score	60.31	8.07	60.31	0.00
Slope of Equity Curve	45,781.60	110.03	45,781.60	0.00

([Click here to enlarge](#))

What is remarkable in Figure #4 is the strategy's outcome at \$295,802,293. It is a 67.22% CAGR over the 15.5 years of weekly trading. Yet, exposure is still only 52%. Carlos slightly increased the strategy's market participation, and in a meaningful way.

We can compare the strategy's results in Figure #4 with the outcome of buying and holding SPY for the duration.

Holding SPY would have generated a 12.25% CAGR over the period with a 99.96% exposure rate. The performance of Carlos's strategy significantly outperforms the SPY results. It surpassed holding SPY by \$295 million by following a simple set of trading rules, as described above.

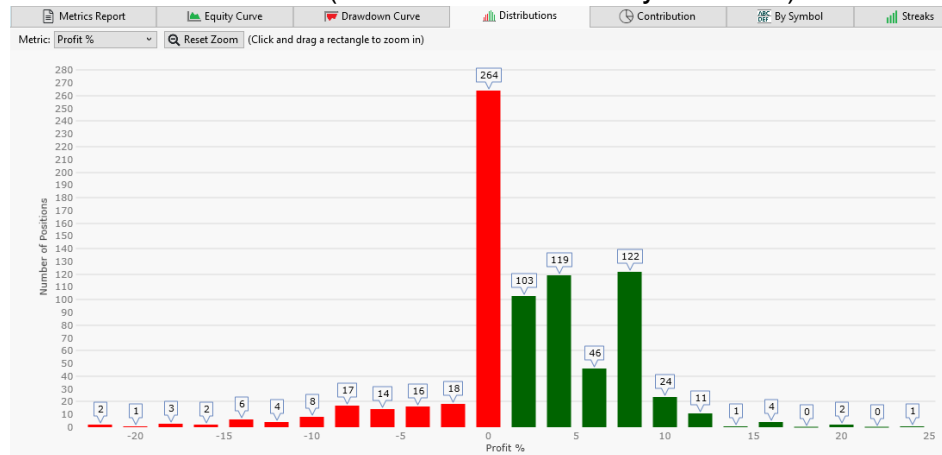
As mentioned many times, these rules could be applied by hand on your cellphone from anywhere and take less than five minutes of your time per week. Your computer program can automate the whole process to a few seconds a week.

Figures #3 and #4 give Carlos' results a clear advantage in using his modified version of the OPPW TQQQ strategy. For anyone using the Wealth-Lab 8 software, they will instantly recognize the layout of those charts and know that only the WL8 software could have generated them.

Carlos was gracious and also provided his WL8 program code that generated Figures #3 and #4. All I had to do was copy and paste and run the simulation. I obtained the same results as expected.

That proof is easy to make.

Figure #5: Trade Distribution (Carlos's version on my machine).



(Click here to enlarge)

Figures #5 and #6 are from his program version of Figures #3 and #4, but on my machine, as of Sept. 2, 2025.

Figure #6: Portfolio Metrics (Carlos's version on my machine).

Sept. 2, 2025

Metrics Report			Equity Curve		
Select ScoreCard: Basic ScoreCard			Select ScoreCard: Basic ScoreCard		
Summary			Positions		
Starting Capital	100,000.00	100,000.00	Position Count	812	1
Profit	307,548,863.57	1,212,267.05	Avg Profit	378,754.76	1,212,267.05
Profit %	307,548.86%	1,212.27%	Avg Profit %	1.14%	1,212.61%
Profit Per Bar	17.47	15.50	Profit Factor	1.59	-
APR	67.58%	18.00%	Payoff Ratio	1.60	-
Std Dev of Annual Ret...	148.34%	20.43%	Avg Bars Held	3.26	3,912.00
Exposure	52.19%	99.99%	Avg Trades Per Month	8.63	0.01
Maximum Exposure	100.00%	100.00%	Avg Bars Held as % of...	0.08	99.97
EAR	129.48%	18.00%	Largest Bars Held as %...	0.13	99.97
Alpha (α)	45.05	-	NSF Position Count	0	0
Beta (β)	1.25	-	NSF Ratio	0.00	0.00
Sharpe Ratio	1.46	1.04	Drawdown		
Sortino Ratio	2.39	1.71	Max Drawdown	-66,691,004.89	-333,824.80
WL Score	60.39	11.59	Max Drawdown Date	3/13/2025	12/28/2022
Slope of Equity Curve	46,268.76	272.18	Max Drawdown %	-53.36%	-35.62%
Interest, Commission...			Max Drawdown % Date	8/22/2011	12/28/2022
Commission Paid	0.00	0.00	Recovery Factor	4.61	3.63
Cash Interest Received	0.00	0.00	Profitable Positions		
Margin Interest Paid	-0.00	-0.00	Count	433	1
Maximum Margin Used	1.00	1.00	Max Consecutive	11	1
Dividends Received	0.00	0.00	% Profitable	53.33%	100.00%
Total Currency Adj	0.00	0.00	Avg Profit	1,907,101.51	1,212,267.05
			Avg Profit %	4.70%	1,212.61%
			Average Bars Held	3.19	3,912.00
			Unprofitable Positions		
			Count	379	0
			Max Consecutive	7	0
			% Unprofitable	46.67%	0.00%
			Avg Loss	-1,367,351.16	-
			Avg Loss %	-2.93%	-
			Avg Bars Held	3.33	-

(Click here to enlarge)

In Figure #6, we have the portfolio metrics for Carlos's program version. It confirms everything he had in his program. The slight difference stems from the added one-day positive trade result compared to his chart.

Figure #6 shows an average profit per trade of 1.14%. It is not that much higher than the 1.02% in my latest simulation. However, we are dealing with a series of compounding returns. Even such a small difference can have a great impact. In this case, generating some \$307 million compared to \$112. We have: $307/112 = 2.74$, and $1.02^{51} = 2.74$, or $1.0159^{64} = 2.74$. It is as if 51 displaced trades averaging a 1.02%, or 64 trades averaging 1.0159% per trade, were the reason for the increase in performance.

It is only one program variation compared to another, aiming to do the same thing, one more successfully than the other. Which one would you prefer?

My interpretation of Carlos' modification could be interesting in itself. In my article, [A WINNER'S GAME](#), I said that I was looking to change about 60 trades from Type-C to Type-B or better. That is about what happened with his program modifications.

By slightly changing the trading rules, all I saw was Carlos being more cautious and going for more chicken moves in the face of market uncertainty. It is not a negative point, on the contrary. His modifications show that even going for less tolerance to losses, you can make more money. It might appear as a contradiction, but it is an expression of what those rule changes, on average, accomplished.

If the price closed below the entry price, he gave his trade some leeway, allowing a -1.3% decline before requesting an exit. But not any exit; he wanted a 2.5% profit instead of requesting nothing, like my Type-C trades. The move is brilliant as it gives the position some leeway and a fuzzy zone where the price can wiggle without the consequence of triggering the stop-loss.

That was a plus for my version of the trading strategy. So much so that it increased the strategy's performance by \$200 million. Being more chicken and cautious in the face of uncertainty is not such a bad thing after all, as Carlos' version of my OPPW TQQQ trading strategy can attest.

Carlos Manuel Azuero Rodriguez, thank you for letting me highlight and showcase your modifications to my OPPW strategy. Bravo for a job well done.

Does this mean that I like Carlos' program modifications? Yes, I do. It also shows that we do not need to make major changes to this trading strategy to see it fly. Try your own modifications; you should have enough that has been said about the behavior of this trading strategy to make your improvements worthwhile, too.

All my best.

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